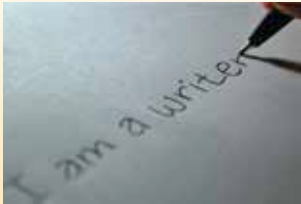


The Writing Process

When starting out with any new endeavour, the major inhibitor is uncertainty and lack of knowledge. With that in mind, here is a section on a typical flow of events, thoughts, and actions for obtaining and executing a freelance writing assignment.

Since there's nothing that expands the mind more than going meta, let's consider this very chapter as the example. A few years back in time, someone is reading his favourite magazine and suddenly a completely blank page catches his eye. It was the magazine's ingenious way of getting writers to

CHAPTER #05



Wordsmithing like your own boss

Today's technologically enhanced marketplace allows you to write away your monetary worries!

Writing is one of the most obvious professional vocations that can be carried out from the comfort of one's home (or internet connected getaway). Since a writing service is inherently an information based trade, the manufacturing of the product is location independent. For example, this very chapter has been written on the other side of the planet. Text can be transferred easily

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and efficiently thanks to the internet, so the most difficult part about being paid to write is actually just deciding to do it. You don't even need to be connected to the internet to write (though you do need it to deliver). In fact, you don't even need technology (though it does make the job a LOT easier). When you write, having an office is a matter of choice. Despite that, our full-time writers work from the Digit office - just an indication that it's a great place to be!

As a freelancer you get to be your own boss, and with writing you have the added advantage of choosing your work. You can write about what you know, what you care about, or what you think others should care about. Writing is not that different from talking (unless you're writing literature) and how easily do you talk? Imagine getting paid to put down what you know (and what others know) in words - yes, freelance writing is a dream!



.. Make the leap!

Freelance writers get paid by various metrics. In India the standard is per word, but in some other countries the standard is a per hour payment policy. Then there are employers who pay per article, and employers who pay a monthly retainer for regular work. Either way, writing freelance can be a lucrative profession given some time and effort. Well-established writers can easily make upwards of an engineer's salary. The best part is, you are only limited by time and your laziness. Unlike salaried professionals, you don't have the insecurity of being laid off, and you don't have to answer to anyone. Take on more work - make more money!

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An example of an article written by a freelance writer

apply (Yes, it was Digit). Fast forward to the recent past, when he is on an email list of freelancers to whom the editorial team sends out emails when assignments are available. This writer is quick to ask for this chapter before it is taken by anyone else. He gets the job, and gets to work.

The topic of this assignment is Freelance Writing, and needs to be written in a 'Getting Started With' kinda way. "How meta! Maybe I can justifiably write about this moment in the article," he thinks, chuckling to himself. Then he considers the task at hand more seriously. In his context, writing